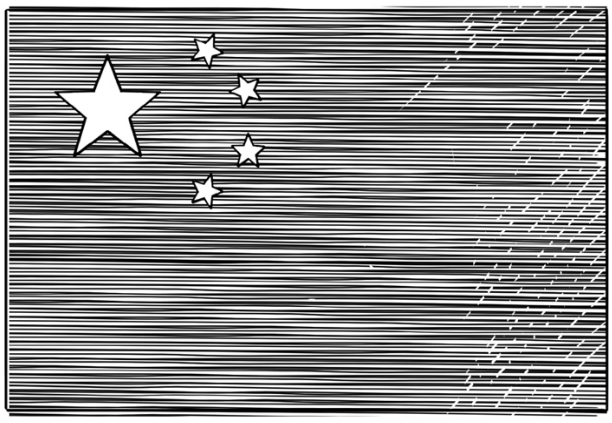
CHAPTER 5
A Violent Chinese Takeover



Flag of the People's Republic of China

In 1949, the Chinese Communist Party took over the government of China. Communists believe that the community, not the individual, should have control over how people live and work.

China bordered Tibet on the north and east. Tibetans had once been ruled by China, but since the early 1900s, they had ruled themselves. The Chinese Communist leader Mao Tse-tung (say: MOU tsuh-TOONG) wanted to control Tibet once again.

Mao Tse-tung (1893–1976)

Mao was born in 1893 to a farming family in China. He liked the Communist idea of government control. And he helped establish the Chinese Communist Party.

In 1949, the Chinese Communist Party took over the government, and Mao became the chairman of the People's Republic of China. His government took over land, farming, and the industries of the country. This led to food shortages and starvation for many Chinese people. He wanted to eliminate all of China's old ways. So he destroyed books and works of art. He closed schools that did not support Communist ideas. Those who didn't agree with him were put in prison or killed.